



September 22nd 2020 Delaware County Council Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ziArtiBXL1c
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Target Category	delaware_county

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Delaware County Council Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: September 22, 2020

Meeting Time: 9:00 AM

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

- **Session Type & Topic:** Budget Hearings ([00:00:11](#))
- **Summary of Discussion:** The council motioned to open the annual budget hearings before immediately recessing them until the conclusion of the regular county council meeting.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the Delaware County Council meeting to order at 9:00 AM ([00:01:26](#)).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Mr. Ballard, Mr. Bledsoe, Ms. Chambers, Ms. Lassiter, Mr. Piper, Mr. Quakenbush (noted in transcript as Crakenbush/Quakenbush), Mr. Alexander

(Presiding Officer), and Mr. Hughes (Attorney).

- **Absent:** None.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by Jessica (00:01:29).
- **Approval of Agenda:** Approved via roll call vote (00:02:43).
- **Approval of Minutes:** Minutes of the last regular meeting approved via roll call vote (00:03:12). Denise noted that special meeting minutes are still being finalized.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:03:57 Communication Center Budget Transfers**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Finance / Department Representative.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Adjustments made to line items to cover Perf and Fica shortages, moving funds out of telephone backup center and OIC lines, and adding to education incentives. Total request equals zero net change.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Unanimous).
- **00:06:52 Circuit Court Budget Transfers**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily Anderson, Court Administrator.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reallocations to replace a resigned pre-trial probation officer (managing 197 clients against a cap of 120) and moving court reporter funds into office equipment (441) to cover COVID-related expenses, computer maintenance plans, reception counters, mail sorters, shelving, and trial risers. Anticipated 100% reimbursement via CARES Act. Total request equals zero.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Unanimous).
- **00:12:50 Health Department Budget Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Health Department Representative.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request to move funds from environmental health specialist to overtime (196) to pay out accumulated comp time for retiring staff due to COVID-19. Lengthy debate ensued regarding the creation of a new permanent overtime line item that would persist in future budgets with zero balances.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to **Table** (00:19:28) approved by Roll Call Vote (Unanimous) to allow restructuring specifically tied to COVID-reimbursable expenses. *(Brought off the table later at 00:41:51 and re-tabled again at 00:53:12 for recalculation).*

- **00:20:29 Jail Budget Transfers**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jail Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfers to refill vacant jailer/correctional officer positions to prevent burning through overtime and forcing double shifts. Total request equals zero.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Unanimous).
- **00:23:36 Sheriff's Department Budget Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sheriff's Department.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer reflecting statutory changes regarding the sheriff's salary set by state representatives/senators (percentage of the prosecutor's salary). Total request equals zero.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Unanimous).
- **00:26:43 LIT Jail Budget Transfers**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jail Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reallocations for correctional officer and overtime lines. Discussion emphasized changing nomenclature from "jailer" to "correctional officer" for clarity. Total request equals zero.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Unanimous).
- **00:26:58 911 Communications Budget Transfers**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** 911 Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Moving money out of supervisor positions into overtime due to being short on part-time floor workers while conducting an ongoing training class. Total request equals zero.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Unanimous).
- **00:28:12 Eligible Homestead Budget Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Department Representative.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Longevity transfer adjustment to cover Fica and Perf for chief deputy pay. Total request equals zero.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Unanimous).
- **00:29:14 First Jail Addendum Transfers**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jail Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Series of line-item shifts into overtime to manage ongoing staffing shortages. Total request equals zero.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Unanimous).
- **00:31:17 Second Jail Addendum (Correction Officers & Cook)**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jail Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Adjustments for correction officers and filling a vacant cook position. Total request equals zero.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Unanimous).
- **00:32:15 LIT Jail Health Insurance & Overtime Addendum**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jail Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Adjustments moving funds from correctional officer lines to health insurance and overtime accounts. Total request equals zero.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Unanimous).
- **00:34:33 Public Defender Second Addendum Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Public Defender Office / Pam McCammon, Human Resources Director.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer to clear a deficit caused by a former employee staying past their intended departure date to vest in PERF. Discussion addressed a separate nepotism question regarding a newly hired family member, noting the public defender board is scheduling a special meeting to ensure complete independent supervision of that employee. Total request equals zero.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Pam McCammon (HR Director) spoke in favor, confirming the applicant is qualified and processes are being handled by the board (00:38:04).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Unanimous).
- **00:50:00 Coordinating Council / Grant Appropriations**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Grant Administrators.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Standard annual/fiscal-year grant appropriations including prevention education grants (\$20,502), intervention treatment grants (\$17,758), and justice law enforcement grants (\$7,421). Total request: \$57,101.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Unanimous).
- **00:56:57 JDAI Grant Appropriations**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Grant Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriations for supplies (\$6,772), client monitoring (\$16,966), travel/training (\$29,011.88), and equipment (\$5,950). Total request: \$58,402.88.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Unanimous).
- **00:58:04 VOCA Grant Appropriations**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Grant Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Funding for child and home-school visitors and family recovery court case managers (\$20,500 total reimbursable grant).

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Unanimous).
- **00:59:05 Family Recovery Court Grant**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily Anderson, Court Administrator.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Funding for program coordinator (\$4,802), FICA (\$368), and PERF (\$538) to cover the remainder of the year. Total request: \$5,708.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Unanimous).
- **00:00:00 Sales Disclosure Fund** (*Note: occurred around 01:00:03*)
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Department Representative.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriations for pictometry (\$5,000) and X-soft software (\$11,000) funded via sales disclosure fees. Total request: \$16,000.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Unanimous).
- **01:04:46 EMS Capital Improvement**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mike Ashley, EMS.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for \$141,783 to re-chassis an ambulance bought second-hand from Madison County for \$5,000 (equipped with a load system and cot valued at \$50,000). Total cost significantly less than buying a new \$235,000 vehicle.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Unanimous).
- **01:02:18 Opioid Grant**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Grant Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Funding for peer recovery coach (\$21,624) and recovery specialist (\$38,376). Total request: \$60,000.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Group Roll Call Vote (Unanimous).
- **01:03:01 Special State Distribution**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Department Representative.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$13,339.14 for bituminous aggregate to close out a one-time 2016 account and remove it from the books.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Unanimous).
- **01:03:56 Comprehensive Omnibus Approval Motion**
 - Motion to approve all financial transfers, amend the salary ordinance with like reductions, and amend hiring freeze ordinance 2020-015. Approved via Roll Call Vote (Unanimous).
- **01:05:31 Harrison Township Capital Improvement Plan (New Business)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Council / Auditor's Office.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Statutory review of the Harrison Township Capital Improvement Plan. State board rules dictate that the council must review and confirm receipt of the plan by statutory deadlines. No formal vote is required, but the minutes must explicitly reflect that the council reviewed the report.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to receive and review the report approved by Roll Call Vote (Unanimous) (01:08:10).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

No members of the public participated during a dedicated public comment period; however, council members shared civic announcements during the forum: - 01:09:06 **Jessica:** Noted that the blood center is in high need of blood donations and mentioned that Versiti blood donation drives (located near the Muncie Mall on Saturdays and Mondays) are currently offering COVID-19 antibody testing with donations. - 01:09:49 **Jane:** Noted that the Association of Indiana Counties (AIC) conference is currently online, paid for by the commissioners, allowing local officials to review training sessions (such as open door laws and zoning updates) remotely until November 1st. - 01:12:11 **Sheriff (via Podium):** Clarified details regarding Versiti blood donation bus schedules in the Muncie Mall parking lot.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** The regular meeting adjourned with instructions for members to return in approximately 15 minutes at 10:30 AM to reopen the annual budget hearings.
 - **Adjournment:** Official adjournment of the regular meeting approved by roll call vote (01:13:46).
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